

FREE CHECKLIST

Before Your Next Hire: An HR Readiness Checklist

Make sure your organization is legally protected before you bring on your next employee.

Use this checklist before every new hire. Check each item to confirm you have the right processes and documents in place. If you cannot check something off that is a gap that needs to be addressed before the offer goes out.

BEFORE YOU POST THE JOB

- 1 ☐ **Job description written and includes FLSA classification**
Clearly defines essential functions, requirements, and reporting structure.
- 2 ☐ **Compensation range benchmarked against market data**
Know what the role pays in your market before you post or make an offer.
- 3 ☐ **Interview questions reviewed for compliance**
Remove any questions about age, family status, national origin, or disability.
- 4 ☐ **Background check process is documented and consistently applied**
Apply the same process to every candidate for the same role.

WHEN YOU MAKE THE OFFER

- 5 ☐ **Written offer letter prepared using your standard template**
Must include title, compensation, classification, start date, and at-will language.
- 6 ☐ **Offer is contingent on background check if applicable**
Document this clearly in the offer letter before the candidate signs.
- 7 ☐ **Benefits summary ready to share with the new hire**
Health insurance, retirement plan, PTO policy, and enrollment deadlines.
- 8 ☐ **New hire salary reviewed against existing team for pay equity**
Avoid creating compression or equity issues before the first day.

BEFORE DAY ONE

- 9 ☐ **I-9 instructions sent to employee before start date**
Employee must complete Section 1 on or before their first day of work.
- 10 ☐ **IT access, equipment, and system credentials are ready**
Nothing signals unpreparedness like a computer that does not work on day one.
- 11 ☐ **Onboarding schedule built for the first week**
Who they meet, what they learn, and what they accomplish in days one through five.
- 12 ☐ **Direct manager briefed on the onboarding plan and their role in it**
Manager knows what their responsibilities are in the first 30 days.
- 13 ☐ **New hire paperwork packet prepared**
I-9, W-4, state tax form, direct deposit, benefits enrollment, handbook acknowledgment.

DAY ONE

- 14** ☐ **Employee completes I-9 Section 1 on or before start date**
Section 1 is the employee's responsibility — confirm it is done on day one.
- 15** ☐ **Employer completes I-9 Section 2 within 3 business days of start date**
Best practice is to complete Section 2 on day one. Must be done within 3 business days.
- 16** ☐ **Employee handbook provided and acknowledgment signed**
Keep the signed acknowledgment in the personnel file permanently.
- 17** ☐ **Benefits enrollment window communicated clearly**
Most plans require enrollment within 30 days of hire. Do not let this slip.
- 18** ☐ **Introduction to team and workplace completed**
First impressions set the tone for the entire employment relationship.

FIRST 30-90 DAYS

- 19** ☐ **30-day check-in scheduled with manager**
Informal conversation about how things are going and any early questions.
- 20** ☐ **60-day performance conversation scheduled**
Address any early performance concerns before they become bigger problems.
- 21** ☐ **90-day review completed**
Formal check-in on performance, culture fit, and role clarity.
- 22** ☐ **Personnel file complete and organized**
All signed documents stored securely and separately from I-9 and medical files.

Need help putting these in place?

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